

Problem #1: Lepcha (15 marks)

Sikkim has 11 official languages, which are listed below in English as well as the *Lepcha Script*.

Nepali ལྟུང་སྐད་, Lepcha ལྷུང་ལྷུང་, Sikkimese སྐུ་ལྷུང་, Tamang ཐུང་ལྷུང་, Limbu ལྷུང་ལྷུང་, Newar ལྷུང་ལྷུང་, Rai ལྷུང་, Gurung ལྷུང་ལྷུང་, Magar ཐུང་, Sunwar ལྷུང་ལྷུང་, English ལྷུང་ལྷུང་

Assignment 1:

The *Lepcha* name for one of the above languages does not match its English name. Which one? It is actually written as **Drendzongke** (dz is pronounced somewhat like the *j* in jug.)

Assignment 2:

The *Lepcha* speakers, who call themselves the **Roong haagiit** (ལྷུང་ལྷུང་), are composed of four main distinct communities: ལྷུང་ལྷུང་, ལྷུང་ལྷུང་, ལྷུང་ལྷུང་, ལྷུང་

Transcribe these four community names into English.

Assignment 3:

Sikkim boasts of the third highest mountain peak of the world, *the Kangchenjunga*. Transcribe this name in the Lepcha script, considering the fact that it is pronounced as **Kaang-chen-dzong-gaa** (means “*the five treasures of the high snow*” in the Tibetan language).

The *Lepcha* script, used for writing the *Lepcha* language, is derived from the *Tibetan* script, and may have some Burmese influence. Around 30 to 50 thousand people speak the *Lepcha* language, who are spread across Sikkim, Northern West Bengal, Bhutan and Nepal.